

Fake Adobe Reader Phishing Attack - September 2026

What happened:

- Attackers sent phishing messages containing malicious links that eventually directed victims to a fake Adobe Reader update page.
- The attackers took advantage of Adobe's trusted name and told victims they needed to update Adobe Reader to view a document.
- The attack used Browser-in-the-Browser (BiTB), creating a fake browser window that appeared to display Adobe's legitimate website.
 - BiTB is a tactic where an attacker spins up an entire fake browser window (including the address bar, URL, padlock icon, favicon, and more) inside the actual webpage content itself, usually using HTML/CSS/JavaScript. Because the window is part of the webpage rather than a separate browser interface, the technique can bypass some of the social-engineering cues users are trained to recognize, such as checking the address bar for a suspicious or illegitimate domain.
- Instead of Adobe Reader, victims were prompted to install ConnectWise ScreenConnect, a legitimate remote-access program being misused by the attackers
- Installing ScreenConnect could give the attackers remote access and persistent control over the victim's computer
- The fake Adobe page and apparent legitimate web address made the download look trustworthy.

Response:

- The Huntress SOC detected and stopped the observed attacks before they progressed further.

Source:

<https://www.huntress.com/blog/phishing-bitb-rmm-attacks>